

9.2.1 cp (copy)

You can use the Unix command `cp` to copy and rename a file in one move. The basic command is: `cp path1 path2`, where the path placeholders represent the names of the original file and the copy, respectively.

9.2.2 Copying in place

To duplicate a file called `FT.doc`, you would type `cp FT.doc FT2.doc`. You need to add a backslash before a space if you want to name the copy file with two words (`FT\ Backup`, for example).

9.2.3 Copying and renaming

To copy the same file into, say, your `Movies` folder at the same time, just change the last part of the command so that it specifies the path, like this: `cp FT.avi ~/Movies/FT2.avi`.

Note

`cp` will replace identically named files without a warning. You need to use the `-i` flag, i.e., `cp -i`, if you want to be warned before `cp` replaces a file in this way.

9.2.3 Copying without renaming

To copy something into another directory without changing its name, just use a pathname in the final part. So, to copy `FT.doc` into your `Movies` folder, for example, you just need to type `cp FT.doc ~/Documents`.

9.2.4 Multiple files

You can even copy several files or directories at once. Where you normally specify the source filename, just list their pathnames separated by spaces. You can also use the wildcards like `*` to copy several files at once.

9.3 Moving and renaming files and directories

9.3.1 mv

To move or rename your files, you use the Unix command `mv`, almost exactly the same way you use `cp` (except that it automatically moves directories inside of directories you're moving, so you don't have to type `-R` flag).

The syntax is: `mv oldfilename newfilename`. For example, to change your `Documents` directory's name to `Docs`, you'd type `mv Documents Docs`. You can rename both files and directories like this.

To rename a file and move it to another directory simultaneously, just replace the last portion of the command with a pathname. All the usual shortcuts apply, including the wildcard.